FORGE Phase 1 · Week 2 · Session 6 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 6: Cognitive Restructuring" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 6 as written already runs the full two hours (10 + 10 + 40 + 30 + 20 + 10 minutes), so the run of show adds no outside talk (an optional one is listed below). Its two short videos take about three and a half minutes of the Instruction segment: one opens Part 1 and one opens Part 3. Every segment keeps its length.

What's in this insert

- **Video 6A, "Cognitive Restructuring"** (1 min 32 s). Why naming the thinking errors isn't enough, cognitive restructuring "in plain English" (catching a bad thought and replacing it with a better one), notice, check, challenge, replace, and the three honest questions one at a time. It ends on the three questions ("Is it accurate? Is it helpful? Is there another way to see this?") and holds them for 20 seconds.
- **Video 6B, "The STOP Technique"** (1 min 58 s). Stop, Think, Options, Plan, letter by letter, with the one breath that "creates a gap between the trigger and your response." Then the guide's common-area example: a shoulder bump, first without STOP and then with it. It ends on "The difference: four letters."
- **No talk in the run of show.** The session is already full; an optional talk is listed below for a make-up session or a segment that runs short.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Opening Circle	10	As written: how are you doing, and did you catch any thinking errors since yesterday?
0:10	Review & Reflection	10	As written: the group names all eight from memory. Video 6A picks up from there ("identifying the problem isn't enough"), so you can go straight into it after the recall.
0:20	Instruction: Cognitive Restructuring and the STOP Technique	40	**Video 6A plays at the start of Part 1** (1½ minutes). If your player allows, pause on its last card so the three questions stay on screen through Part 2. Part 2, Challenging Thinking Errors, as written: each error with its challenge. **Video 6B plays at the start of Part 3** (2 minutes). Use the rest of Part 3 to have the room say the four words back, then walk one or two small situations from the men's own week through STOP out loud.
1:00	Practice/Exercise: Rewriting Thinking Reports	30	As written. Put the Original / Restructured table on the easel.
1:30	Debrief & Discussion	20	As written, including After → During → Before.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
1:50	Checkout & Assignment	10	As written.

Notes on the videos

- **Part 2 is yours.** The eight challenges ("Did the judge put the drugs in my car?", "Am I living by Service Over Self or Service Over Everyone Else?") work best said by you, in person, with room for the men to push back. Neither video repeats them.
- **The shoulder bump itself is not shown.** The footage shows one man stopping short, taking a breath, and walking on. There is no confrontation on screen.
- **"The real world doesn't pause for you."** The Debrief's honest question, "Can you actually use this stuff in real life?", is not in the videos. Keep it for the Debrief.

Optional talk (if time allows)

Session 6 already runs the full two hours, so this talk is **not** in the run of show above. Use it for a make-up session, when a segment runs short, or as preparation for yourself.

Sean Stephenson, ***The prison of your mind*** (TEDxIronwoodStatePrison 2014, 10 minutes 26 seconds). A therapist born with a bone disease that left him three feet tall, speaking to the men inside Ironwood State Prison. Three lessons: never believe a prediction that doesn't empower you; you are not your condition; the real prison is in your mind.

1. He calls "bullying yourself" the most dangerous habit there is. Take one thing you say to yourself when something goes wrong and run it through the three questions: is it accurate, is it helpful, is there another way to see it?
2. "Never believe a prediction that doesn't empower you." What prediction has someone made about you, or have you made about yourself, that you have been treating as a fact? Write an alternative thought for it in your alternative thought bank.
3. He says the mind chatters all day, and freedom starts with noticing the chatter instead of obeying it. Where does STOP fit into that?

Preview note: he describes painful medical treatment, makes a passing joke about being offered heroin, and closes with "God bless." There is no graphic content. He was speaking to incarcerated men, and it shows.

- **YouTube** (TEDx Talks): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VaRO5-V1uK0

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Playing the videos without internet

Download both videos from forgementors.org/media.html onto the playback device before the session. They are FORGE's own videos, so there is no outside license to ask for, and they can be shown to every cohort. Check them against the facility's rules for media like anything else you bring in.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 6A and 6B loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Easel paper or board ready for the Original / Restructured table